MONEY MADE SIMPLE · CHECKLIST + SCRIPTS + TRACKER

The Bill Cut Kit

Find every recurring charge in ten minutes, cut the ones you don't use, and use word-for-word scripts to lower the bills you keep.

~60 minutes, once | 7 call scripts | Savings tracker | Any bank



Edition 1.0

Educational content. Not financial advice.

START HERE

What's inside

One sitting, about an hour, with your phone and a drink. You'll end with a list of every recurring charge, a decision on each, and a number: how much you just freed up per year.

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How to use the tracker

The spreadsheet that came with this kit (**Bill-Cut-Tracker.xlsx**) has three tabs: **Audit** (every recurring charge and your decision), **Negotiation Log** (every call, the old price and the new one) and **Summary** (your total yearly savings, worked out for you). It opens in Excel, Google Sheets (File → Import → Upload) and Apple Numbers.

- **Yellow cells** are inputs. Type over them.
- **White cells** calculate themselves.
- It comes filled in with a made-up example so you can see how it works. Clear the yellow cells, then add your own.

THE RULE OF THE KIT

Always look at the **yearly** cost, not the monthly one. $14.99 a month sounds small. $180 a year is a plane ticket. The tracker converts everything to yearly for you.

PLEASE READ

This kit is general education about organising your own bills. It is not financial, legal or insurance advice. Prices, policies and offers vary by company and change often; the scripts are starting points, not guarantees of a discount. Before you drop or reduce any insurance, make sure you still have the cover you need (and any cover your lender or state requires).

STEP 1 · 10 MINUTES

Find every recurring charge

Subscriptions hide in five places. Check all five, write each charge on the Audit tab (or the worksheet on page 8), and don't decide anything yet.

1. **Your bank and card statements, last 3 months.** Search or scroll for anything that appears more than once. Three months catches quarterly charges; also search the last 12 months for words like *annual*, *renewal*, *membership* and *.com* to catch yearly ones.

2. **Your phone's app store.** iPhone: Settings → your name → Subscriptions. Android: Google Play → profile picture → Payments & subscriptions → Subscriptions. These often bill under "Apple" or "Google", so they're invisible on your statement.

3. **PayPal and other wallets.** PayPal: Settings → Payments → Manage automatic payments. Also check any "buy now, pay later" apps you use.

4. **Big retailers.** Amazon: Accounts & Lists → Memberships & Subscriptions (Prime, Subscribe & Save, channels). Check Walmart, Costco and similar if you use them.

5. **Your email.** Search your inbox for *"receipt"*, *"your subscription"*, *"renews"*, *"trial"* and *"membership"*. This finds the things billed to a card you forgot you had.

Don't forget the "bills" that are really subscriptions

HOME

Internet, TV, streaming add-ons, home security, renters insurance, storage unit.

PHONE & TECH

Phone plan, device protection, cloud storage, extra phone lines nobody uses.

LIFE

Gym, apps, meal kits, memberships, warranty plans, car insurance, bank account fees.

TIP

Write the **renewal date** next to anything annual. Cancelling the day after an annual renewal usually means you've paid for the year; cancelling the week before usually means you haven't.

STEP 2 · 15 MINUTES

Keep, cut, downgrade or negotiate

Go down the list once. Every line gets exactly one of four decisions. The tracker adds up what each decision saves.

KEEP

K

You used it in the last 30 days and you'd buy it again today at this price.

CUT

C

You haven't used it in 30 days, or you forgot it existed. Cancel it this week.

DOWNGRADE

D

You use it, but not all of it. Cheaper tier, ad-supported plan, annual billing, fewer lines.

NEGOTIATE

N

You need it, but the price is negotiable: internet, phone, insurance, card APR, fees.

Three questions that settle most decisions

- **"If I didn't have this, would I sign up today at this price?"** If the answer is no, it's a Cut or a Downgrade.
- **"Do I have two of these?"** Two music apps, three video services, two cloud storage plans. Keep one. Rotate streaming services: subscribe for the month you're watching something, then cancel.
- **"What's the cost per use?"** A $40 gym you visit twice a month is $20 a visit. A $10 app you open daily is 33¢ a day. Cost per use is a fairer test than price.

Annual billing: when it's worth it

Many services charge less if you pay yearly (often around two months free). Only switch something to annual if you marked it **Keep** and you've used it for at least three months. Switching something you barely use to annual locks in waste.

```
monthly cost × 12 = yearly cost   |   weekly × 52   |   quarterly × 4
```

Worked example (made up)

Charge	Billed	Yearly	Decision	Saves / yr
Second video streaming service	$15.49 / mo	$185.88	Cut	$185.88
Cloud storage, 2 TB	$9.99 / mo	$119.88	Downgrade to 200 GB ($2.99)	$84.00
Phone plan	$75 / mo	$900	Negotiate → $55	$240.00
Meditation app	$69.99 / yr	$69.99	Keep	$0
Total freed up				**$509.88**

Prices above are illustrative, not quotes from any company.

STEP 3 · 15 MINUTES

Cancel cleanly, so it stays cancelled

The goal isn't just to cancel. It's to never see the charge again, and to have proof if you do.

1. **Cancel where you signed up.** App store subscriptions must be cancelled in the app store, not by deleting the app. Retailer add-ons are cancelled in the retailer account. Deleting an app never cancels a subscription.
2. **Look for "pause" or a cheaper plan first** on things you marked Downgrade. Many services offer one in the cancel flow.
3. **Screenshot the confirmation** (page or email) and note the date on the Audit tab. If a charge shows up later, that screenshot is your evidence.
4. **Check next month's statement.** Put a 2-minute reminder in your calendar for one month from today: "Did the cancelled charges stop?"
5. **If a company keeps charging after you cancelled,** contact them first with your screenshot and ask for a refund. If that fails, dispute the charge with your card issuer or bank and explain that you cancelled on [date]. Card issuers have their own dispute rules and time limits, so act within a month or two of the statement.

Free trials: the 30-second habit

When you start any free trial, immediately put a calendar reminder two days before it converts: "Cancel X or keep it?" Some services let you cancel the same day and still use the trial to the end, which is the safest option. Check the terms before you do that.

When you can't find how to cancel

- Search "*[company] cancel subscription*" and use the company's own help page (watch out for look-alike sites that ask for card details).
- Use the company's chat or phone line and say: *"I'd like to cancel my subscription today. Please confirm by email."* You don't have to give a reason.
- Some banks and card apps let you see or block recurring merchants. Use this as a backup, not instead of cancelling: blocking a payment doesn't end a contract you still owe on.

> **CAREFUL WITH CONTRACTS**
>
> Phone, internet and gym contracts can carry early-termination fees, and financed phones can have a remaining balance. Check before you cancel; sometimes downgrading or waiting until the contract end is cheaper.

STEP 4 · 20 MINUTES

Negotiation scripts: the big three

Internet, phone and insurance are where the real money is. Spend five minutes checking competitor prices first, then call. Be friendly, be specific, and be willing to say "I'd like to cancel then."

Before you call (2 minutes each)

- [ ] Your current price, what's included, and when you signed up.
- [ ] One or two real competitor offers for similar service in your area, with the price.
- [ ] Your account number and the security answer they'll ask for.

Internet or TV provider

"Hi, I've been a customer for [X years] and my bill has gone up to [$current]. I'm looking at [competitor] for [$offer] a month for similar speed. I'd rather stay. What can you do on my price?"

If they say no: "Could you transfer me to the retention or loyalty team? I'm thinking about cancelling."

If they offer something: "Thanks. Is that the best you can do? Does it change my contract or add any fees? How long does that price last?"

Phone plan

"I'd like to review my plan. I use about [X GB] of data a month. Is there a cheaper plan that covers that, or any current promotions for existing customers? I'm comparing with [carrier / prepaid option] at [$offer]."

Then ask: "Are there lines, insurance or add-ons on my account I'm still paying for?" (Check the bill for device protection and extra lines.)

Car or renters insurance

"I'm reviewing my policy before renewal. Can you check that I'm getting every discount I qualify for? For example: bundling, paperless or autopay, safe driver, low mileage, and good student if that applies."

"What would my premium be with a [higher deductible amount]?" (A higher deductible lowers the premium but means you pay more yourself if you claim. Only choose one you could pay from savings.)

Then get two or three quotes from other insurers for the same cover, and compare like for like.

LOG EVERY CALL

Put the date, who you spoke to, the old price, the new price and how long the new price lasts in the Negotiation Log. Set a reminder for when a promo price ends, and call again then.

STEP 4, CONTINUED

More scripts: cards, fees, memberships

Credit card: lower APR

"Hi, I've had this card for [X years] and I pay on time. My APR is [X%]. I'm working on paying the balance down and I've had offers from other cards. Could you lower my interest rate?"

If no: "Okay, thank you. Is there a hardship or payment plan program, or any promotional rate available on my account?" Hardship programs can come with conditions (like a frozen card), so ask what they are before agreeing.

Credit card: late fee or annual fee

Late fee: "I missed my payment by [X days], which isn't usual for me. I've paid it now. Would you be able to waive the late fee as a courtesy?"

Annual fee: "I'm deciding whether to keep this card because of the annual fee. Is there a retention offer, or can I switch to a no-fee version of the card without closing the account?" (Switching keeps the account history, which can matter for your credit.)

Bank account fees

"I was charged a [monthly maintenance / overdraft] fee of [$X] on [date]. Could you refund it? And what do I need to do to avoid this fee in future?" If fees keep happening, many banks and credit unions offer accounts with no monthly fee.

Gym or membership

"I'd like to cancel my membership. Please tell me exactly what I need to do, any fee involved, and send me written confirmation." If you want to keep it: "Do you have an off-peak or lower-tier membership?"

Things that make calls work better

- **Be pleasant to the person.** They didn't set the price, and they're far more likely to help someone who's nice to them.
- **Silence is fine.** After you ask, stop talking and let them look.
- **Ask "is that the best you can do?" once.** Then decide.
- **If the answer is no, call back another day.** A different person may have different offers available.
- **Get it in writing.** Ask for an email confirming the new price and how long it lasts.

PRINT ME

Audit worksheet

Date: _____ Next check (in 6 months): _____

Charge	Amount	How often	Yearly	K / C / D / N	Saves / yr
Total saved per year					

Call log: company	Old price	New price	Until	Spoke to

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STEP 5 · THE IMPORTANT ONE

Give the money you freed up a job

Money you stop spending on subscriptions has a habit of quietly disappearing into everything else. Decide where it goes today, while the number is fresh.

- **Set up an automatic transfer** for your monthly savings (Summary tab, "per month") to a separate savings account, on the day after payday.
- **Or point it at your highest-interest debt** as an extra payment every month.
- **Repeat this audit every six months.** Put a calendar reminder in now. Subscriptions creep back.

Want the whole month to feel like this?

The Bill Cut Kit fixes the leaks. **The 20-Minute Budget** is the system that keeps them fixed: your bills, savings and goals run on autopilot, and the rest of your spending becomes one weekly number you check in 20 minutes a week.

NEXT STEP

The 20-Minute Budget

14-page guide + spreadsheet with a weekly check-in, sinking funds and an avalanche vs snowball debt planner.

$12

Bill Cut Kit buyers: use code **BILLCUT5** for $5 off, so this kit pays for itself.

EVERYTHING

The Money Made Simple Toolkit

All five kits: Bill Cut, 20-Minute Budget, Credit Report Audit, Debt-Free Date Planner and Start Investing With $100 a Month.

$39

Saves $23 against buying them one by one.

Find both at [your store link]. Educational content only, not financial advice.